



**SUPERIOR COURT OF SAN MATEO COUNTY**

**Probate - Probate**

**Courtroom 2C**

**Hearing Date: 07/22/2026 - 09:00 AM**

07/13/2026

9:51 AM

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**Judge:** Novak, Lisa A.

**Clerk:** Ortega, Alexandrina

**Reporter:** Conde, Wendy

**Tentative Ruling:**

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL (Zoom not allowed)

The declaration in support of the petition for SIJF is insufficient, in that it appears to be a single statement, written in the third person, yet verified by both the minor and proposed guardian. The matter will be continued for the minor to submit his own declaration which spells out in detail his home life before coming to the United States, as well as any and all contact or communication with his parents since his arrival. He shall include whether he has ever provided his parents with a phone number by which they could contact him, whether he has provided them any information so that they could communicate with him electronically or on social media, and whether or not he has provided them his current address. The next hearing is October 5, 2026 at 9:00 a.m.

|                     |                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                             |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>26-PRO-00194</b> | <b>In Re the Matter of the Collins/Steinfist Family Trust, dated November 10, 2005.</b>                                                                                  | PETITION TO ESTABLISH TRUST INTEREST OVER PERSONAL PROPERTY |
| <b>Line 10</b>      | Petitioner: Howard, Julia (SEKSARIA, JENNIFER P.)<br>Petitioner: Zaretsky, Michael (SEKSARIA, JENNIFER P.)<br>Decedent: COLLINS, SHARON<br>Decedent: STEINFIRST, JOHN F. | Petition Hearing                                            |

**Tentative Ruling:**

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

Amended Petition (1) to Establish Trust Interest Over Personal Property; and (2) for Instructions is GRANTED absent cogent objection.

|                     |                                                                                 |                                                                 |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>26-PRO-00197</b> | <b>IN THE MATTER OF THE ESTATE OF BRUCE HEGEDUS</b>                             | PETITION FOR ORDER TO PRODUCE WILL AND DAMAGES; PROPOSED ORDER. |
| <b>Line 11</b>      | Petitioner: Mollica, Christine (MENDELMAN, JEFFREY)<br>Decedent: HEGEDUS, BRUCE | Petition Hearing                                                |



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**APPEARANCE OPTIONAL**

Decedent died December 20, 2025. This Petition for Order to Produce Will and Damages was filed February 13, 2026, alleging that decedent's spouse, the purported custodian of his will, had not lodged it within the statutory 30-day time frame. That date would have been January 20, 2025. The will was lodged April 7, 2026. As such, any request in the petition to order decedent's spouse to produce the will is moot. Acting as a court of equity, the Court can certainly understand why a spouse, who just lost her husband, might not file his will within 30 days of his death, what with all of the other priorities as well as emotional impact taking priority.

Petitioner seeks damages, but that request is unsupported by billing records and the Attachment A referenced in the supplemental filed July 15, 2026. The Court is not inclined to grant any alleged damages as it has not been proven that petitioner suffered any damages in the short period of time from January 20<sup>th</sup> until April 7<sup>th</sup>.

However, if petitioner still seeks monetary damages, the matter is CONTINUED to November 10, 2026 at 9:00 am for Petitioner to file and serve Exhibit A that appears to be missing from her Declaration filed on 7/15/2026, and for Petitioner to file billing records and receipts for the damages she is requesting. The Petitioner should attach a copy of the trust of Eleanor Falstrom for which petitioner is the trustee. If any damages are awarded, they will not include any fees following the lodging of the will.

|                     |                                                                             |                                                                                                              |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>26-PRO-00198</b> | <b>The Purported 2000 James W. Norman and Mabel Kay Norman Revocable</b>    | The Petition seeks the following relief pursuant to Probate Code sections 850, 859, 17200, 17206, and 17211: |
| <b>Line 12</b>      | Petitioner: Jones, LaVerne Norman (Pro Se)<br>Respondent: Norman, Mabel Kay | Petition Hearing                                                                                             |

**Tentative Ruling:**

**NO APPEARANCE (Zoom allowed)**

Petition is CONTINUED to November 13, 2026 at 9:00 am for Petitioner to file a proof of service/notice of hearing that complies with Probate Code 851(a) and (c). Specifically, DE-115 should be used, not DE-120, 30 days notice must be given, a copy of the petition and any supplemental documentation thereto must be served, and the notice of hearing must include the required language contained in PC 851(c). The defective proof of service filed also does not list the Respondent, and names an attorney, but no information as to whom that attorney represents. Petitioner filed her initial pleading on 2/13/2026, and then filed what she labeled as "Memorandum